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THE TRUCARE Tribune

Corporate Nurse answers your question, "What is a Care Plan?"

National Nursing Home Week: *Team Care*

Spring is in the Air: Activities with Jay

TruCare Therapy Solutions Celebrates National Occupational Therapy Month

STEIN & ASSOCIATES

Corporate nurse, John Ferguson, discusses the importance of Care Plans

Care Planning is a process that communicates resident care throughout their stay to all of the members of the resident care team. The care plan is done following an assessment of the resident identifying physical needs of a patient with covert psychological, emotional, and social needs. The care plan should be focused on the individual as a whole person not as a disease or medical problem. The purposes of the nursing care plan are:

- To provide a framework for nursing care
- To promote quality, client-centered care
- To promote continuity of care
- To provide for evaluation of the effectiveness of nursing care
- To promote communication among nursing staff and other health team members.

The components to a care plan are problems, goal interventions and evaluation of the plan. The problems can be either actual or potential. This allows for proper interventions to care for the resident's needs as well as developing a preventative plan to decrease the risk for the development of other care needs. There should be an initial plan of care created within 24 hours of admission to guide other members of the resident care team and provide appropriate measures to follow. Following the comprehensive assessment done over the next few days following admission, a comprehensive care plan is done reflecting the resident's individual problems or needs. The care plan should be interdisciplinary, representing all disciplines that provide care for the resident (nursing, dietary, therapy, social services, and activities).

The goal or expected outcome statement describes client behaviors that would demonstrate a reduction, resolution, or prevention of a particular problem identified in the nursing diagnosis. Goals/expected outcome statements should be:

- Client-centered
- Measurable and observable
- Time-limited
- Reasonable and realistic

Nursing interventions are based on the nursing diagnoses and identified goals/expected outcomes. Nursing interventions identify what the nurse is to do to reduce, resolve, or prevent each of the problems expressed in the nursing diagnoses. It is necessary that the interventions be individualized to meet the total biological and psychosocial needs of the patient. As in all phases of the nursing process, it is important to include the patient and family or significant others in the process of planning and implementing appropriate nursing interventions.

The care plan is a living, breathing document that changes and evolves based on the changes to the resident and the effectiveness of the interventions. When implementing the interventions, the nurse must document care given to the patient. Proper documentation of the resident's response to care is essential to making the care plan be effective. Evaluation of the care plan allows for understanding of progress or lack of progress toward goal achievement and the effectiveness of the interventions provided. The care plan must also be continuously reviewed to ensure evaluation of the patient's response to nursing care and readjustment of that care as required. With any changes to the residents' condition, the care plan must be updated to reflect the care that needs to be provided.

The key to care planning is communication of the process throughout the interdisciplinary team. The electronic medical record allows for a seamless process to let all of the care team know when changes to the care plan are initiated.

National Nursing Home Week is a nationwide observance that invites citizens to celebrate and promote the relationships that exist between nursing home residents, family members, staff and the community.

The theme of this year's event is "Team Care", which recognizes residents an patients in long-term care settings, the dedicated staff caring for them, and the value of care planning where everyone "pitches in" for optimal outcomes.

Join us for a week of celebration May 12-18! Stay tuned for more announcements.

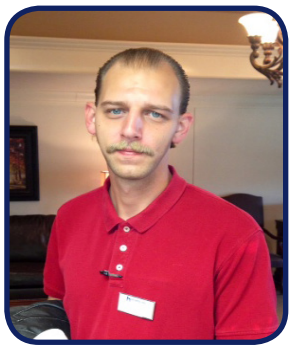
WELCOME NEW EMPLOYEES

Tamie Armstrong has joined the team at Trucare Living Centers a the Marketing/ Admissions Coordinator. "I look forward to working with the team at Trucare, and bring with me over 25 years of marketing, administrative, and management experience," Tamie shares. Tamie was born and raised in Palestine, TX where sher she later raised her 2 sons and now enjoys being a grandmother to her 4 grandchildren. Tamie expresses how excited she is to settle into her role here and become the liaison between TLC and the Palestine community.

Catherine Purser, LMSW is the new Social Services Director at TLC Palestine. Her responsibilities include: assessment, treatment, supportive care, and preserving and enhancing social functioning. Prior to joining the TLC team, Catherine worked in the medical and mental health social work field at several companies,
Including: Trinity Mother Frances, Beacon Hospice, and Rusk State Hospital. She has recently completed her supervision to

WELCOME NEW EMPLOYEES *(cont.)*

obtain her LCSW licenser. Catherine is thrilled to be an integral member of the Trucare team and will soon be contributing a regular column to the Trucare Tribune.



Shawn Guston, the new Housekeeping Supervisor, is excited to server the residents and their family. His experience in long term care goes back to the age of 14, when he began volunteering and singing country and wester music for the residents. After exploring other career options, Shawn was lead back to the nursing home industry where he has been a CNA, Medical Transportation, Assistant Maintenance, and now, Housekeeping Supervisor. "I have been working in skilled nursing facilities for 6 years now," Shawn shares. "I enjoy working around so many interesting people." Shawn enjoys the stories of the past you can hear in the halls of a nursing homes and loves learning about the past from a residents point of view. "I'm passionate about my work and singing-- stop me in the hall to hear a little Conway, Jones, and maybe even a little Elvis," Shawn says, " I'm always willing to lend a hand, an ear, or anything to make your stay a little better."

In March, early spring was bustling at TLC Palestine. The courtyards were beginning to bloom and residents enjoyed the longer hours on sunshine. For Easter, we put a twist on the traditional Easter Egg Hunt by filling the eggs with money. Residents would be surprised with anywhere from $1-$5 dollars after searching high and low throughout the facility common areas and courtyards. March weather also allowed for a lovely day out at Reagan Park. There was fun and games to be enjoyed by all whether it was a board game under the pavilion or a walk in the sunshine. The day wouldn't have been complete without a brown bag lunch picnic style.

In early April, the Activities department held a garage sale fund raiser. Employees and residents donated clothing, books, accessories, and other goodies. There was a great crowd that turned out on a sunny Saturday to shop the merchandise which was proudly priced and displayed by our residents. The fund raiser was a great success!

Prom 2013

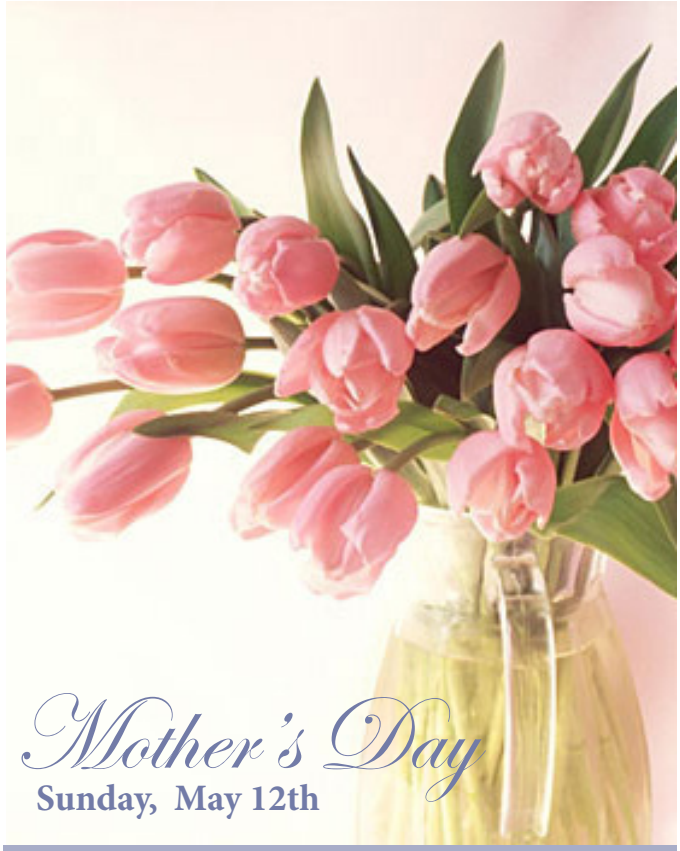
On May 9th TLC Palestine will host a prom for the residents and their families. The theme for this event will be "Old Hollywood". There will be live entertainment, gourmet refreshments and plenty of space for dancing! Goodwill of East Texas will be donating men and women's formal clothing for residents, and the TLC staff will do make-up and hairstyles! The dining hall will be decorated to our fit our "Old Hollywood" theme, and Jay will make corsages. This is sure to be a night our residents will never forget.

CELEBRATE
with TLC Palestine

At TLC Columbus, there is always a reason to celebrate-- healing and recovery, nursings giving high quality care, another day of life.

The spring holds many special occasions. We welcome friends, family, and volunteers to share in the fun with us. Stop by the front desk for your copy of the monthly activities calendar.

On Valentine's Day, TLC Palestine hosted a sweet party where residents enjoyed refreshments with their loved ones. Each of our lady residents were presented roses, while our male residents were gifted with a chocolate cigar. Finally, the moment we had been waiting for, the announcement of the 2013 Valentine's King and Queen elected by staff and residents. This year's title went to Celeader Cook and & Clarence Winston.



Mother's Day kicks off National Nursing Home Week. We will be taking glamour shots of our lovely ladies and showing our appreciation to all of our Mothers.

Letter From the Administrator

Dion Tankersley Talks About Quality Care and the Staff Who Makes it Possible

I want to thank all Trucare employees for the hard work and dedication they display on a daily basis. This is truly the best team I've had the privilege of working with over my 11 years as administrator. This team set a record high census of 97 in February 2013.

We pride ourselves in maintaining compliance with our regulatory agency, Department of Aging and Disability Services (DADS). Over the first quarter DADS made 2 separate visits for self-reports and complaint investigations and all were unsubstantiated. We also had a Quality Monitor visit in January to ensure we are using best practices while providing quality care to our residents.

I want to thank the owners and corporate staff of Stein LTC for the fun, exciting and educational Admin/DON meeting and the on-going support provided to us at the facility. The company has provided facilities with Silverchair Learning in order for all employees to have the most current and up-to-date training possible.

The following individuals deserve Thanks for all the support they give Trucare:

- Linda Grant for providing interim social services to our facility and residents.
- Valerie Rushing, Staff Ombudsman, for assisting and supporting our facility, residents and families.
- Andrea Nicholson and Billie Richardson for the caring and compassion they provide our residents through their devoted volunteer services.

Pamela Cook, Administrator in Training, has been completing her 1000 hour internship at Trucare since the beginning of 2013 and has approximately 1 month remaining to completion. She has been a tremendous asset for the facility and we wish her all the best in her future endeavors as a licensed administrator.

Whether you choose Trucare or another facility we want to be a resource for the Palestine community so please feel free to contact us for questions, suggestions and/or comments in person or by email at dtankersley@tlc-palestine.com

We appreciate the community's continued support and hope this newsletter is beneficial and informative. If you wish to receive the quarterly newsletter electronically please sign-up at the front desk or email me at dtankersley@tlc-palestine.com

Dining Experience

We would like to invite all family members and friends to come out and enjoy a meal with residents. Meal tickets can be purchased through the Business Office for $3.00, this includes the salad bar.

TLC has a gorgeous, private dining room that will accommodate 8-10 people. If you would like to reserve this room, please call the facility in advance. You are welcome to bring in food, cake, etc; or we will be glad to serve you from the kitchen.

Therapy Corner

NATIONAL OCCUPATIONAL THERAPY MONTH

In celebration of National Occupational Therapy Month, TruCare Solutions Occupational Therapy staff will be providing various resources throughout the month of April to educate everyone about the services and benefits of Occupational Therapy.

Occupational Therapy can assist a person in the recovery process after an injury to maximize function and regain valuable skills, aid patients in staying as independent as possible, and provide strategies and/or adaptation to people of all ages.

KEEP AN EYE OUT....

In the near future, TLC Palestine's TruCare Solutions Therapy Department will hold a contest in celebration of National Occupational Therapy Month! There will be fun activities to participate in, and prizes will be given out.

TruCare SOLUTIONS

Empowering You.

The Dietary Scoop

Healthcare Services will be involved in many resident events over the next 3 months. We have a well trained and experienced team of professionals in our Dining Services Department , and we would like to introduce them to you.

- Tina Harrison, *Morning Cook*
- Robert Farris, *Evening Cook*
- Romelder Dunbar, *Relief Cook*
- Gwen Black, *Morning Dietary Aid*
- Domanique Page, *Relief Dietary Aid*
- Janice Sanders, *Relief Dietary Aid*

This dietary team has over 100 years of combined experience planning and preparing delicious and well balanced meals. We all cherish the residents at TLC Palestine and strive to make their dining an experience- as it should be. We want to thank all of the residents that share their feedback at the Council meetings (held on the last Monday of each month). We are honored to serve each and every one of you.

Schedule of Events

April 10th- "Meal of the Month"
Beef Enchilada's, Spanish Rice, Refried Beans, and Wedding Cookies. Nachos will be served at 11:30 am, prior to meal service.

April 22nd- "Earth Day"
Refreshing finger foods provided to residents to replenish their energy after a day of giving back to our good earth.

May 5th- "Cinco de Mayo"
Residents will celebrate with a Mexican fiesta. Service will begin at 5pm for the Residents that eat in their rooms and 5:30 in the dining room.

June 21st- "First Day of Summer"
There will be a beach party with refreshments and home made ice cream.

STEIN
&ASSOCIATES
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TLC
Trucare Living Centers
Palestine

Visit our website and follow us on facebook to keep up with our happenings.

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